

The Last Light

Written by

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FADE IN:

1 INT. OBSERVATORY - NIGHT 1

A telescope turns beneath the open dome. Stars burn over the sleeping city.

MAYA CHEN
(quietly)
There you are.

A red point of light moves against the constellations.

ELI
Tell me that's a satellite.

MAYA CHEN
It isn't.

CUT TO:

2 EXT. CITY ROOFTOP - NIGHT 2

The skyline flickers. Every window goes dark at once.

ELI
That wasn't the grid.

Maya raises a battered field radio. Static answers her.

MAYA CHEN
The observatory has an independent circuit.
(then)
Something switched off the sky.

3 EXT. RIVERSIDE AVENUE - NIGHT 3

Traffic coasts to a silent halt. Drivers step into the street and stare upward.

JUNE PARK, 30s, pushes through the gathering crowd with a camera in hand.

JUNE PARK
Maya? If you can hear me, call back.

Her camera screen flares white. One frame remains: the red light, now impossibly close.

4 INT. OBSERVATORY - CONTROL ROOM - CONTINUOUS 4

Emergency lamps pulse along the floor. Eli studies a wall of dead monitors.

ELI

You said it was moving against the stars.

MAYA CHEN

No. The stars were moving around it.

The radio crackles.

JUNE PARK (V.O.)

Maya, look east.

5 EXT. CITY ROOFTOP - CONTINUOUS

5

Maya crosses to the dome opening. Beyond the river, a second red light rises.

Then a third.

MAYA CHEN

June, get underground.

JUNE PARK (V.O.)

What are they?

Maya watches the lights arrange themselves into a perfect line.

MAYA CHEN

An answer.

6 INT. OBSERVATORY - CONTROL ROOM - MOMENTS LATER

6

Eli drags a steel cabinet across the door. Maya tunes the radio through bands of static.

ELI

Please tell me the basement has more than canned peaches.

MAYA CHEN

It has a seismograph, two bicycles, and six hours of battery.

The radio snaps into sudden clarity.

MISSION CONTROL (V.O.)

Observatory Seven, report your sky.

Maya and Eli exchange a look.

MAYA CHEN

Three objects. Stationary over the river. All ground power is gone.

MISSION CONTROL (V.O.)

They aren't stationary.

7 EXT. RIVERSIDE AVENUE - NIGHT**7**

June runs as the crowd surges toward the subway. Above them, the red lights stretch into glowing vertical lines.

A LITTLE BOY stands alone beside an abandoned bus.

JUNE PARK

Hey! Blue jacket! Come with me.

She takes his hand. A low vibration ripples through the pavement.

8 INT. OBSERVATORY - CONTROL ROOM - NIGHT**8**

Ink needles jump across the seismograph. Eli tears off the paper.

ELI

That's not an earthquake.

MAYA CHEN

It's a signal.

She lays the paper beside an old star chart. The peaks align with three marked coordinates.

MAYA CHEN (CONT'D)

They've been here before.

9 INT. SUBWAY STATION - NIGHT**9**

June guides the boy down a stalled escalator. Hundreds wait below in the emergency glow.

LITTLE BOY

My dad says stars are already gone when we see them.

JUNE PARK

Some are. Most are still fighting.

Her radio chirps.

MAYA CHEN (V.O.)

June, can your camera transmit?

JUNE PARK

For about nine minutes.

MAYA CHEN (V.O.)

I only need one.

10 EXT. OBSERVATORY DOME - PRE-DAWN**10**

Maya bolts June's image sensor to the telescope while Eli pedals a bicycle generator below.

ELI
This is humiliating technology.

MAYA CHEN
Keep pedaling.

The telescope turns toward the nearest red line. On the monitor, darkness resolves into thousands of tiny mirrors.

ELI
What do they reflect?

Maya magnifies the image. In every mirror: the same blue planet beneath unfamiliar constellations.

MAYA CHEN
Home.

She keys the transmitter.

MAYA CHEN
If you can hear us, we are still here.

For a long beat, nothing.

Then the city lights return one block at a time, drawing a path toward the river.

11 INT. SUBWAY STATION - PRE-DAWN 11

Phones wake across the platform. June's camera begins to upload.

The little boy smiles at the ceiling as the vibration becomes a deep, harmonic chord.

12 EXT. CITY - DAWN 12

The red lines fold inward and vanish. Morning breaks across the skyline.

On the observatory roof, Maya finds one red point remaining in the brightening sky.

ELI
An answer?

MAYA CHEN
A promise.